KAVACH
ANTIVIRUS
Powered by Cecil Baraik

User Manual

How to use every page of Kavach

Kavach Antivirus v1.1.2 · Windows 10 / 11

Developed by Cecil Baraik

github.com/cecilbaraik19/Kavach · November 2026

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1. Welcome to Kavach

Kavach means *armour* in Hindi. It is an antivirus for Windows 10 and 11 that finds and stops viruses, trojans, ransomware, spyware and other harmful programs on your PC.

What Kavach does for you:

- **Scans** your PC on demand: quick, full, custom (a folder or pen drive) or running programs.
- **Watches** your files all the time and stops a threat a few seconds after it is saved.
- **Stops ransomware** with hidden bait files, and stops **hidden PowerShell attacks** that never save a file.
- **Scans pen drives** by itself the moment you plug them in.
- **Locks threats away** in an encrypted quarantine, where they can never run.
- **Checks** what starts with Windows, your hosts file and which programs use the internet.
- **Keeps itself up to date**: new detection rules every day, and new Kavach versions from GitHub.

> **Good to know**
> Kavach runs as a **Windows service** in the background. Protection keeps working even when the Kavach window is closed or nobody is signed in. Keep Microsoft Defender turned on as well — no single antivirus catches everything.

2. Installing and opening Kavach

Installing

1. Download **KavachSetup-1.1.2.exe** from **github.com/cecilbaraik19/Kavach/releases**.
2. Double-click it. Windows may say *Unknown publisher*, because the installer has no paid code-signing certificate yet. Click **More info** → **Run anyway**, then **Yes**.
3. Click **Next** → **Install** → **Finish**. The installer also starts the Kavach protection service and adds Kavach to Windows' ransomware-protection allowed list.

Opening Kavach

Press the **Windows key**, type **Kavach** and open **Kavach Antivirus**. Kavach also has a **shield icon** near the clock (click the **^** arrow if you don't see it). Double-click it to open the window.

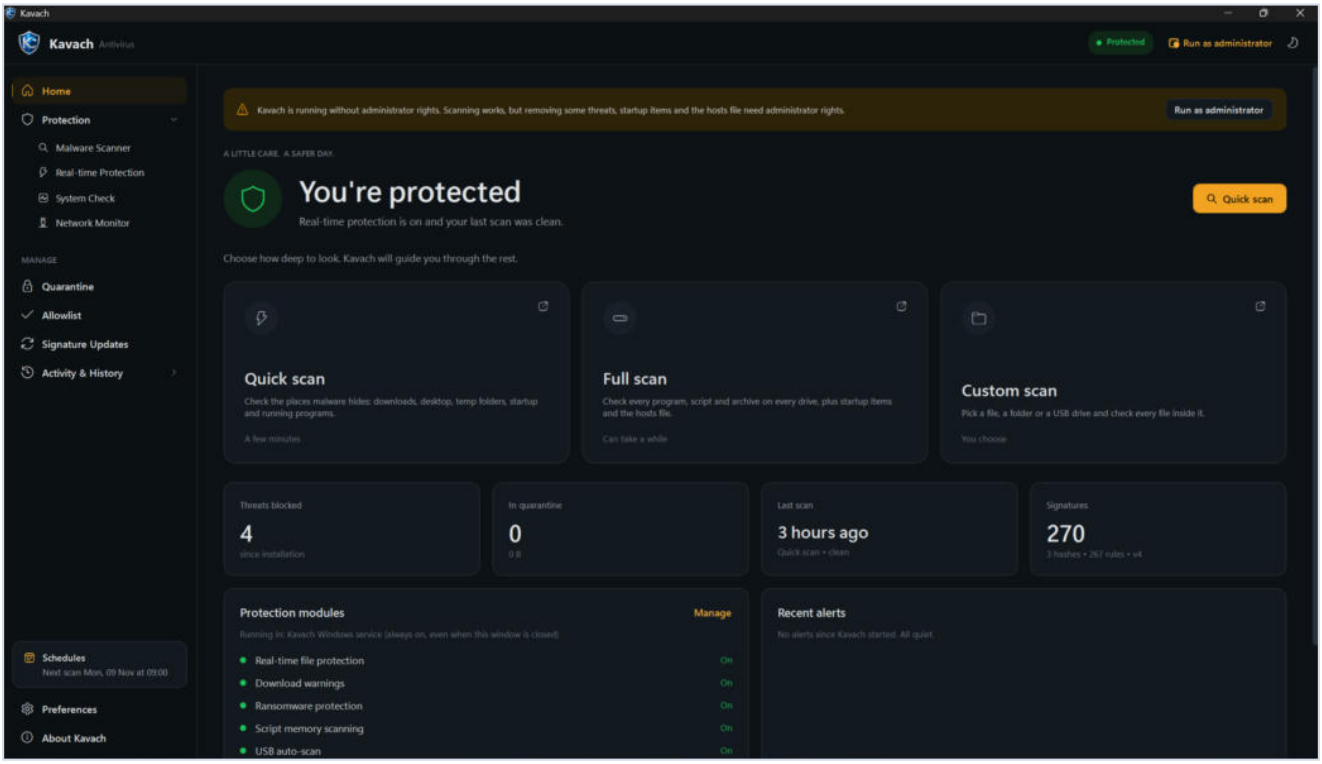
The screen layout

- **Left menu**: every page of Kavach. **Protection** and **Activity & History** open a small sub-menu.
- **Top bar**: the green **Protected** badge (it turns amber or red if something is off), **Run as administrator** and the **moon/sun** button for dark or light theme.
- **Schedules card** (bottom-left): shows your next planned scan.

> **Run as administrator — when do I need it?**
> Normal mode is enough for scanning and protection. Administrator rights are needed only to remove some threats in system folders, disable startup items or repair the hosts file. Click **Run as administrator** at the top when Kavach asks for it.

3. Home page

The Home page tells you at a glance whether your PC is safe, and starts a scan with one click.

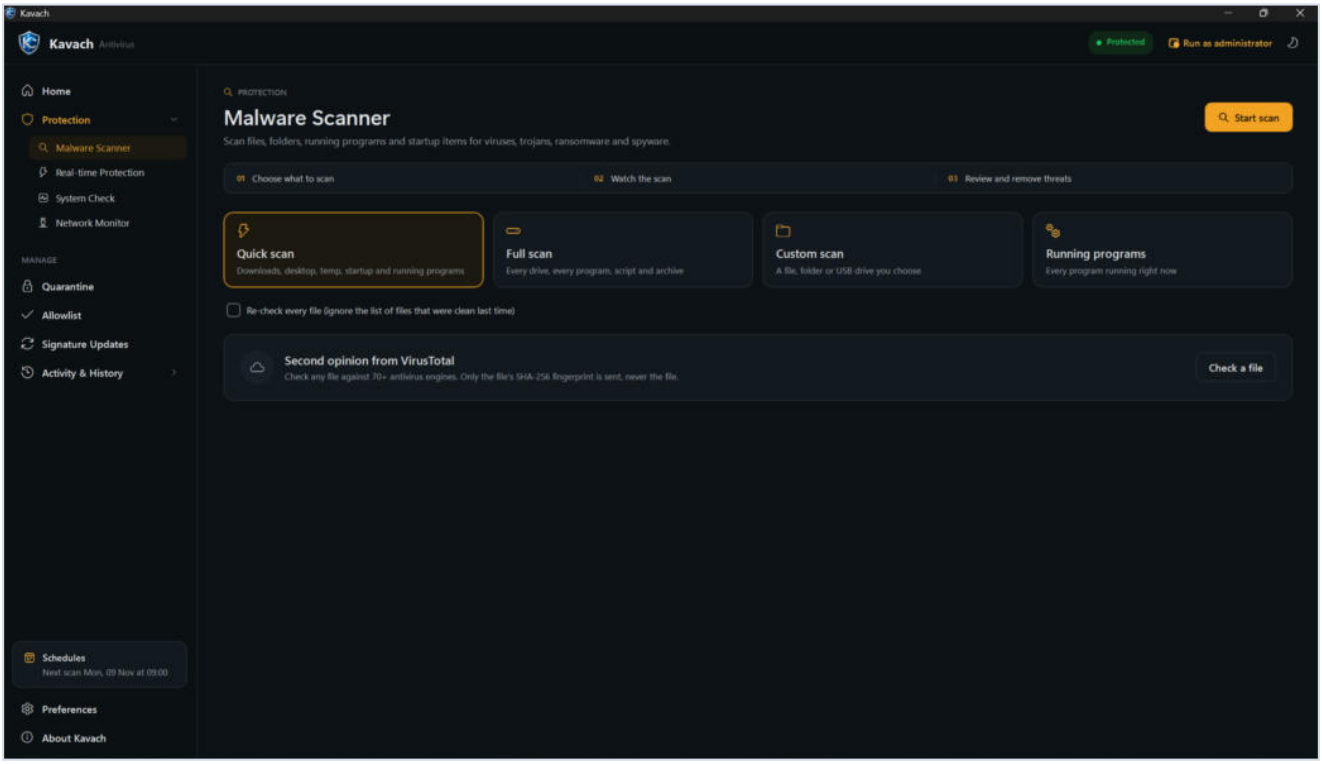


Home page — “You're protected”, the three scan cards, counters and protection modules

- **You're protected**: real-time protection is on and the last scan was clean. If not, the message tells you what to fix.
- **Quick scan** button: starts the fastest useful scan straight away.
- **Quick / Full / Custom scan cards**: click one to open the Malware Scanner with that scan chosen.
- **Counters**: threats blocked since installation, files in quarantine, last scan, and signatures loaded (hashes + rules).
- **Protection modules**: each protection feature with On / Off. Click **Manage** to change them.
- **Recent alerts**: the latest threats Kavach stopped.

4. Malware Scanner

Open it from **Protection** → **Malware Scanner**. Use it whenever you want to check your PC yourself.

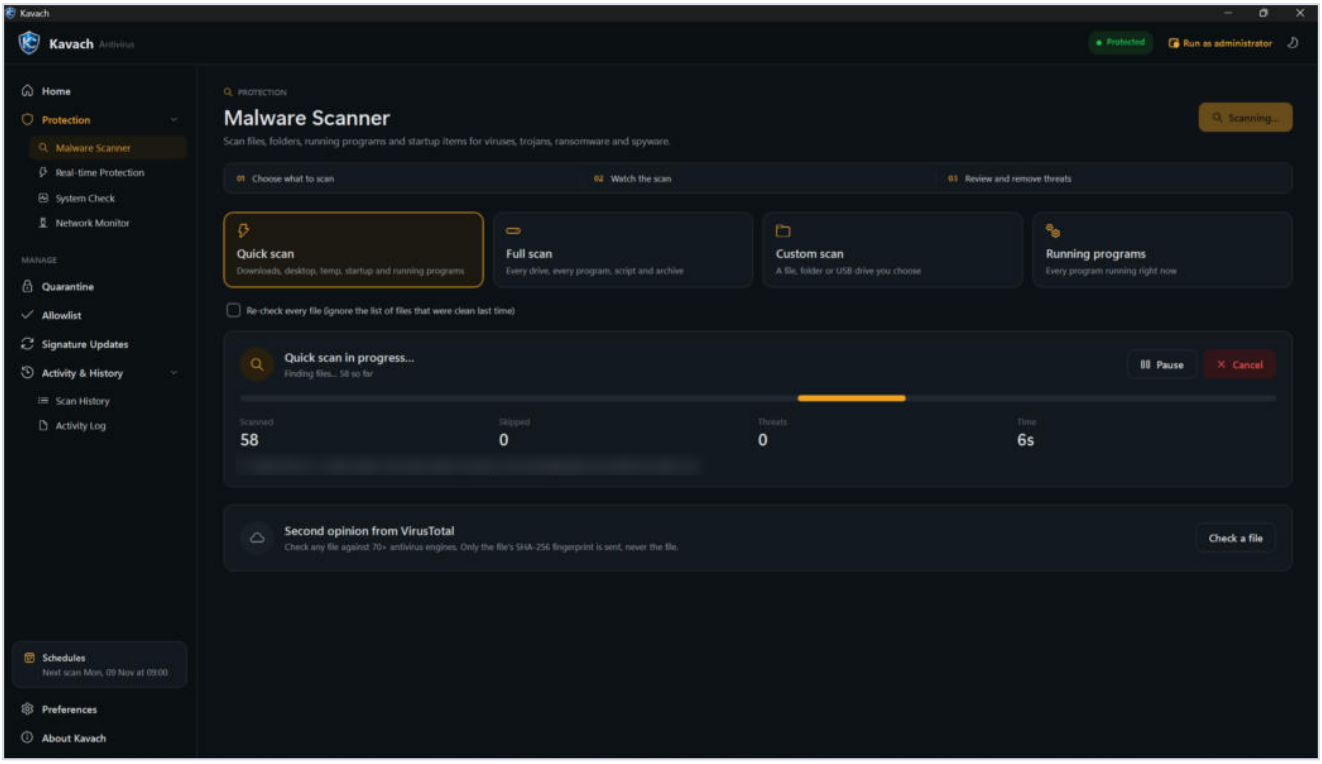


Malware Scanner — pick a scan type, then click Start scan

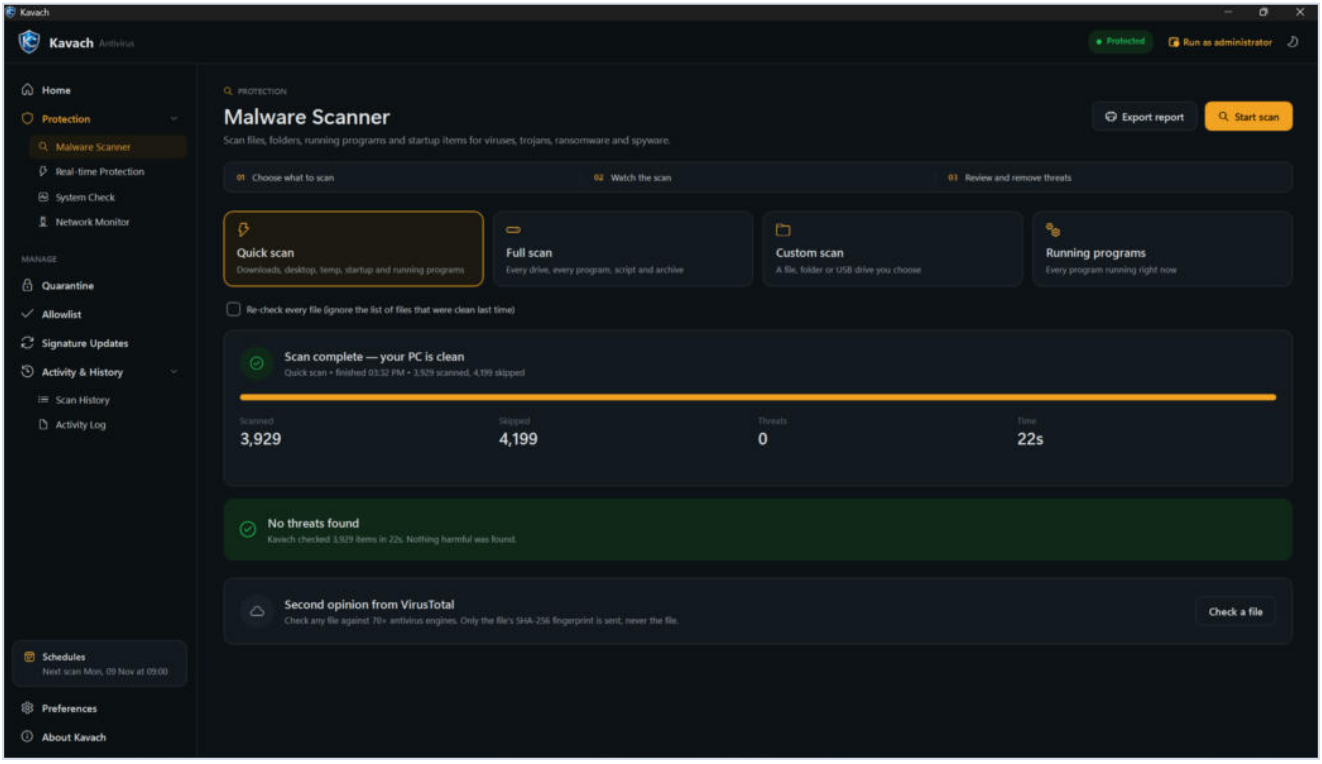
Choose a scan type

Scan	What it checks	When to use it
Quick scan	Downloads, Desktop, Documents, temp folders, startup folders and running programs	Every day or when something feels wrong (about 20–60 seconds)
Full scan	Every drive: every program, script and archive, plus startup items and the hosts file	Once a week, or after you removed a threat
Custom scan	A file, a folder or a USB drive you pick	A new download, a pen drive, a project folder
Running programs	Every program that is running right now	When the PC is slow or behaves strangely

1. Click a scan card (it gets an amber border).
2. Click **Start scan** (top-right).
3. Watch the progress: files scanned, skipped, threats found and time. You can **Pause** or **Cancel**.
4. When it finishes, read the result. Threats appear in a list with buttons to quarantine, delete or allow them.



A Quick scan in progress — with Pause and Cancel buttons

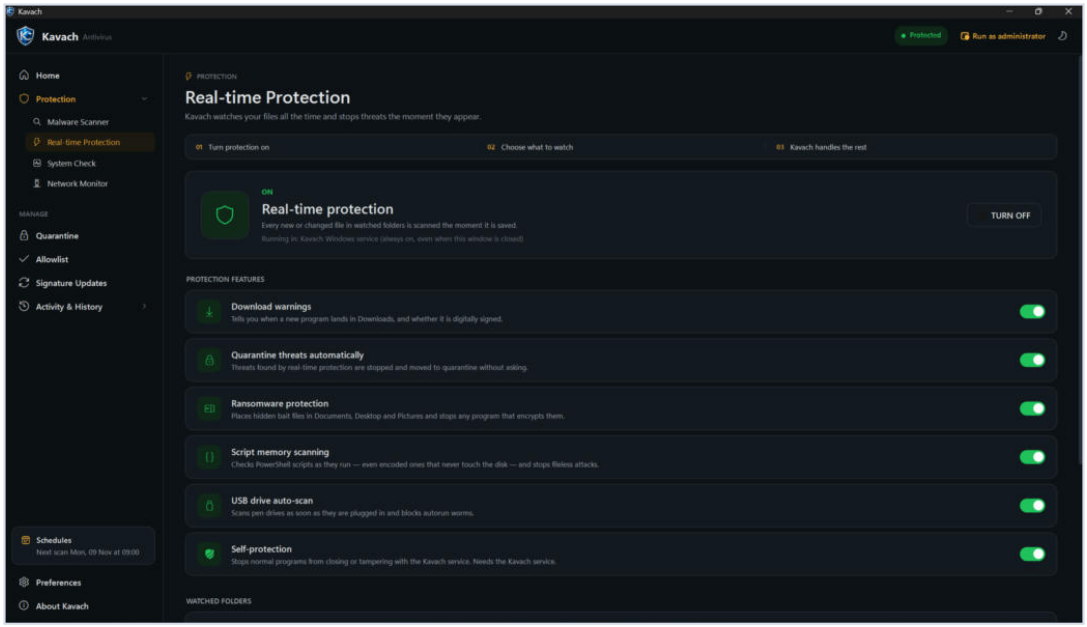


Scan complete — your PC is clean. Click Export report to save a PDF, CSV or TXT report

- **Re-check every file**: Kavach normally skips files that were clean last time and have not changed. Tick this to check everything again.
- **Export report**: saves the result as a **PDF**, **CSV** or **TXT** file.
- **Second opinion from VirusTotal**: checks one file against 70+ antivirus engines. Only the file's fingerprint (SHA-256) is sent, never the file. Needs a free VirusTotal API key in Preferences.

5. Real-time Protection

Open it from **Protection** → **Real-time Protection**. This is Kavach's always-on guard.



Real-time Protection — the main switch and each protection feature

Feature	What it does
Real-time protection	Every new or changed file in watched folders is scanned the moment it is saved. Use **TURN OFF / TURN ON**.
Download warnings	Tells you when a new program lands in Downloads, and whether it is digitally signed.
Quarantine threats automatically	Stops threats and moves them to quarantine without asking you first.
Ransomware protection	Hides bait files in Documents, Desktop and Pictures. A program that changes them is stopped at once.
Script memory scanning	Checks PowerShell scripts as they run — even encoded ones that never touch the disk — and stops fileless attacks.
USB drive auto-scan	Scans pen drives as soon as they are plugged in, and blocks autorun worms.
Self-protection	Stops normal programs from closing or tampering with the Kavach service.

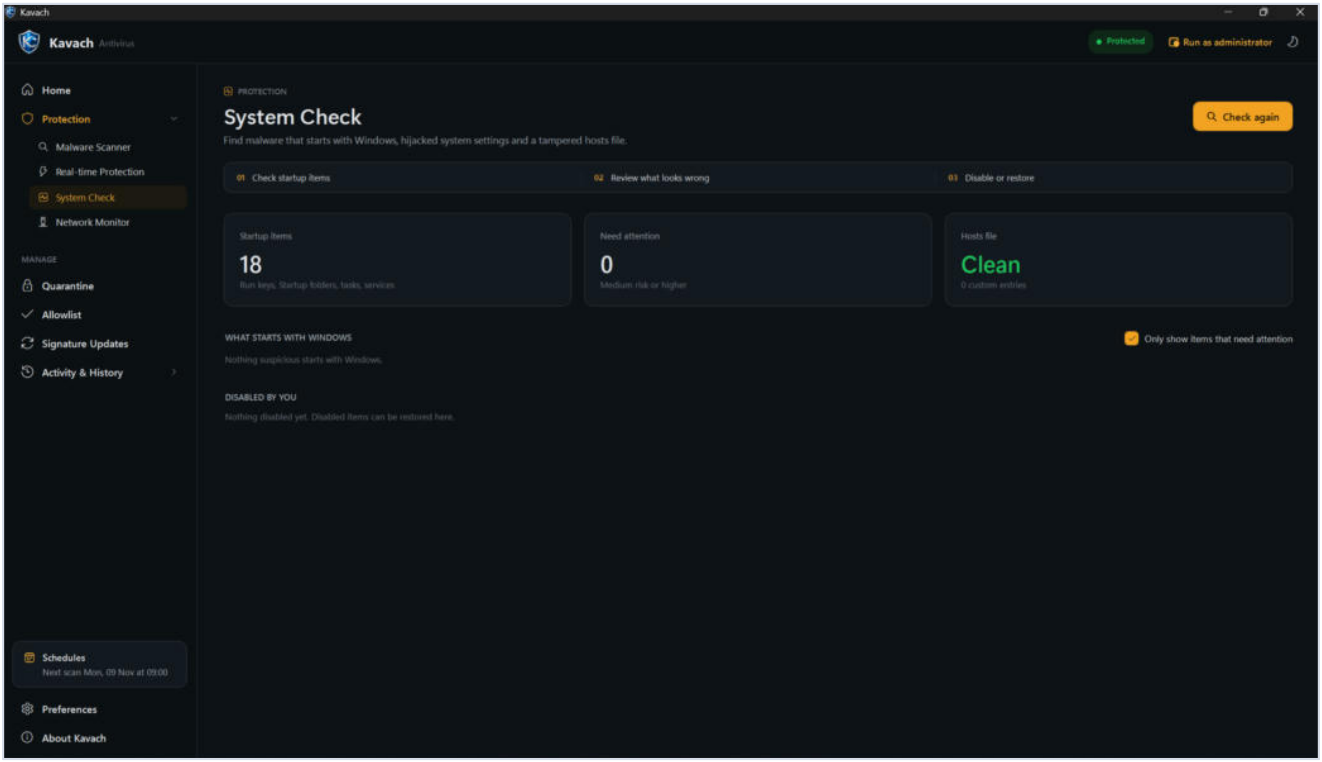
Watched folders

Scroll down to see the folders Kavach watches (Downloads, Desktop, Documents, temp and startup folders). Click **Add folder** to watch another one, for example a project folder.

> **Keep it on**
> Leave real-time protection and all its features **On**. If a settings password is set, Kavach asks for it before anything is turned off.

6. System Check

Open it from **Protection** → **System Check**. Malware loves to start itself with Windows or to change your hosts file to send you to fake websites. System Check looks at both.



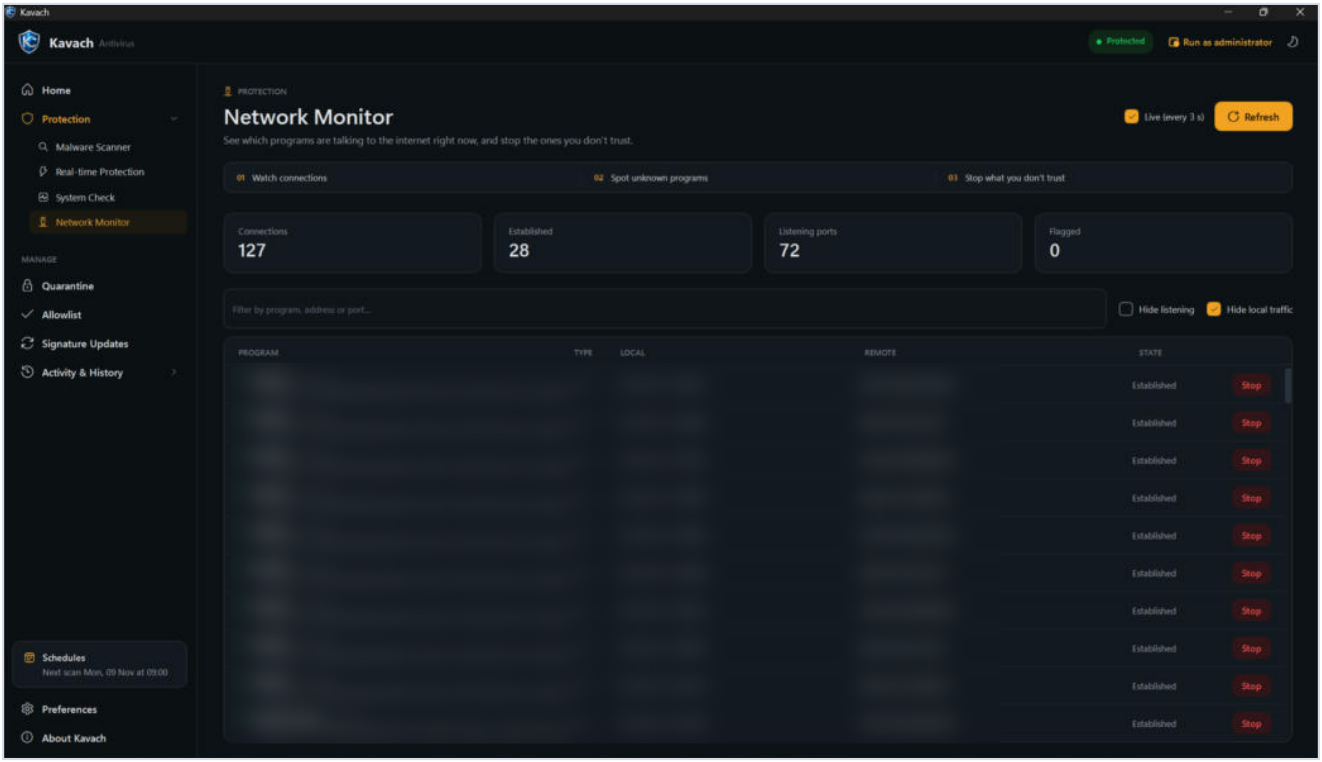
System Check — startup items, items that need attention, and the hosts file

- **Startup items**: everything that starts with Windows (Run keys, Startup folders, scheduled tasks, services).
- **Need attention**: items rated medium risk or higher. **0** is what you want.
- **Hosts file**: **Clean** means no website has been redirected.
- Each item shows a label: **OK** (signed, trusted), **NOTE** (worth a look, usually harmless), **MEDIUM / HIGH** (suspicious). Use **Folder** to see the file, **Disable** to stop it starting.
- **Disabled by you**: everything you disabled. You can restore it here at any time.
- **Only show items that need attention**: hides the normal items.

> **Tip**
> A **NOTE** like “The program it starts is missing (leftover entry)” means a program was uninstalled or updated but its startup entry stayed behind. It is harmless.

7. Network Monitor

Open it from **Protection** → **Network Monitor**. It shows which programs are talking to the internet right now.

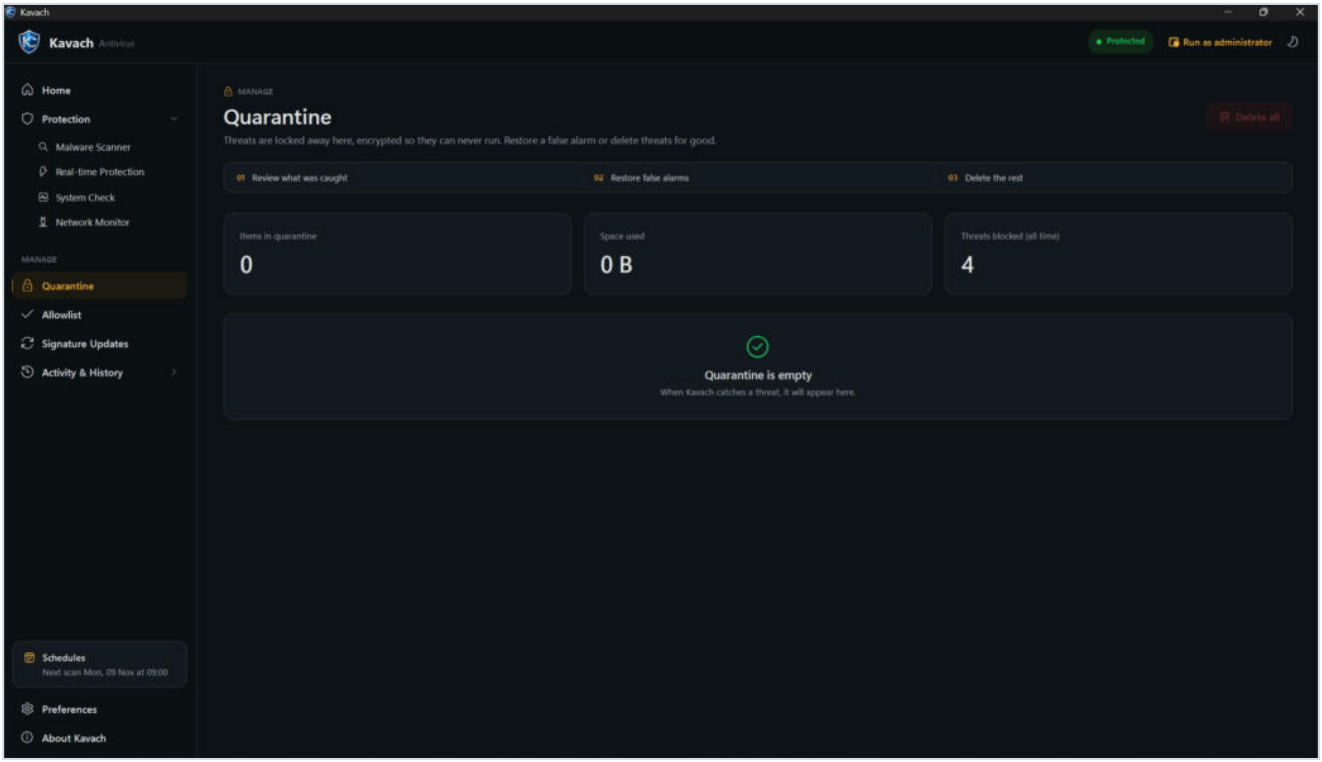


Network Monitor — every connection with its program, addresses and state (details blurred for privacy)

- **Connections / Established / Listening ports**: how many connections are open.
- **Flagged**: connections to known bad addresses or from suspicious programs. **0** is what you want.
- **Live (every 3 s)**: keeps the list updated. **Refresh** updates it once.
- **Filter** box: type a program name, address or port to find it.
- **Stop**: ends a program you do not trust. Only use it on programs you know are unwanted.

8. Quarantine

Open it from **Quarantine** in the left menu. Threats are moved here and **encrypted**, so they can never run.



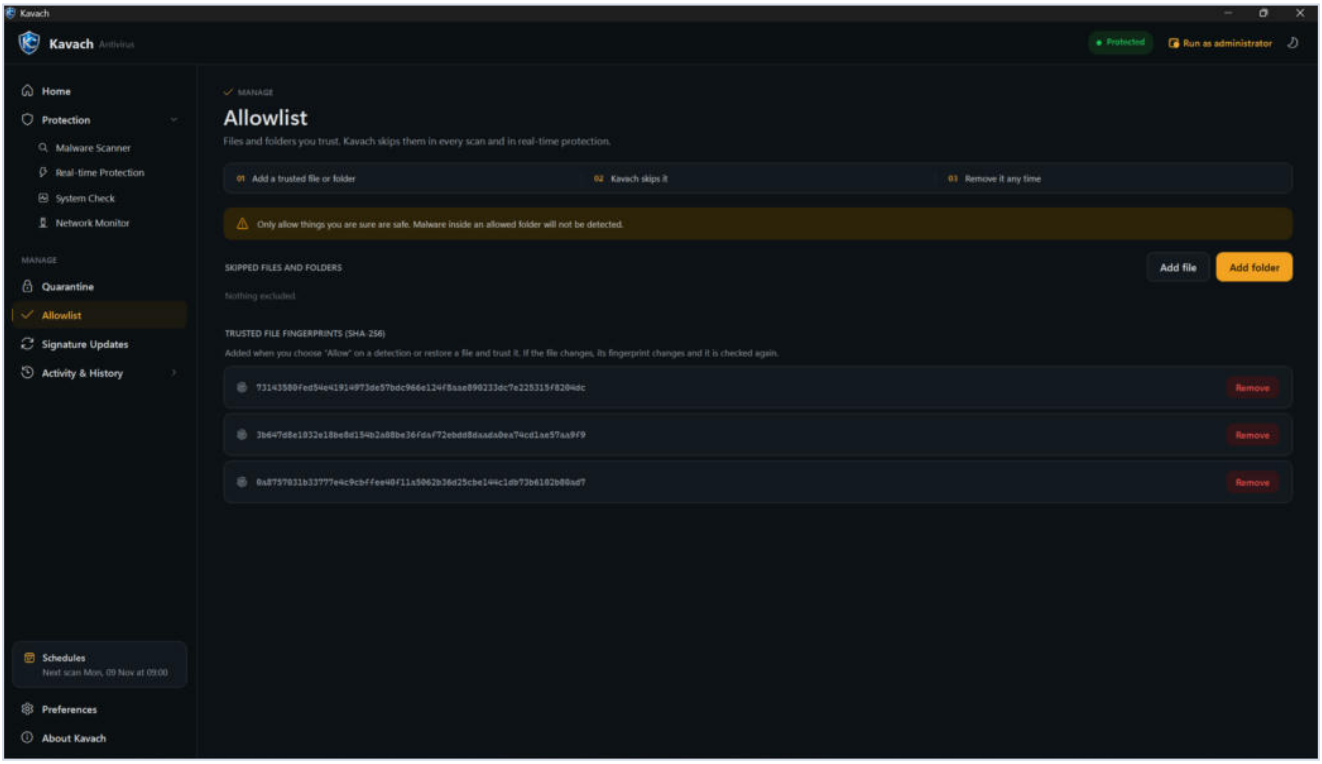
Quarantine — empty means there is nothing locked away right now

- **Restore**: puts a file back where it was. Use it only for false alarms — files you are sure are safe. Kavach offers to trust the file so it is not caught again.
- **Delete**: removes one threat for good.
- **Delete all**: removes everything in quarantine for good.
- The counters show how many items are kept, how much space they use and how many threats were blocked in total.

> **Not sure?**
> If you don't know whether a file is safe, leave it in quarantine. It cannot harm your PC there.

9. Allowlist

Open it from **Allowlist**. Files and folders here are trusted, and Kavach skips them.



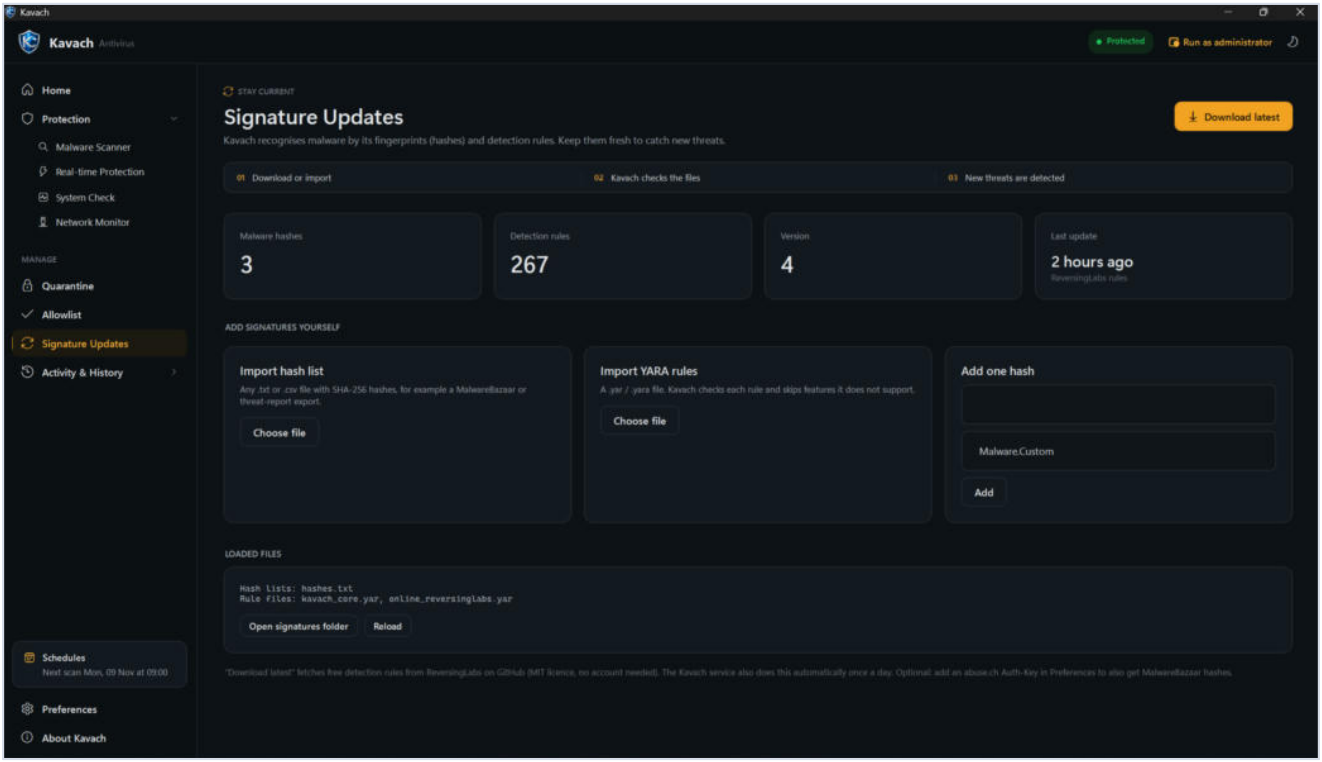
Allowlist — skipped folders and trusted file fingerprints

- **Add file / Add folder**: trust a file or a whole folder.
- **Trusted file fingerprints (SHA-256)**: files you restored or allowed. If such a file changes, its fingerprint changes too, and Kavach checks it again.
- **Remove**: stop trusting it.

> **Be careful**
> Only allow things you are sure are safe. Malware inside an allowed folder will **not** be detected.

10. Signature Updates

Open it from **Signature Updates**. Kavach recognises malware by **hashes** (fingerprints of known malware files) and **detection rules** (patterns that match whole malware families).

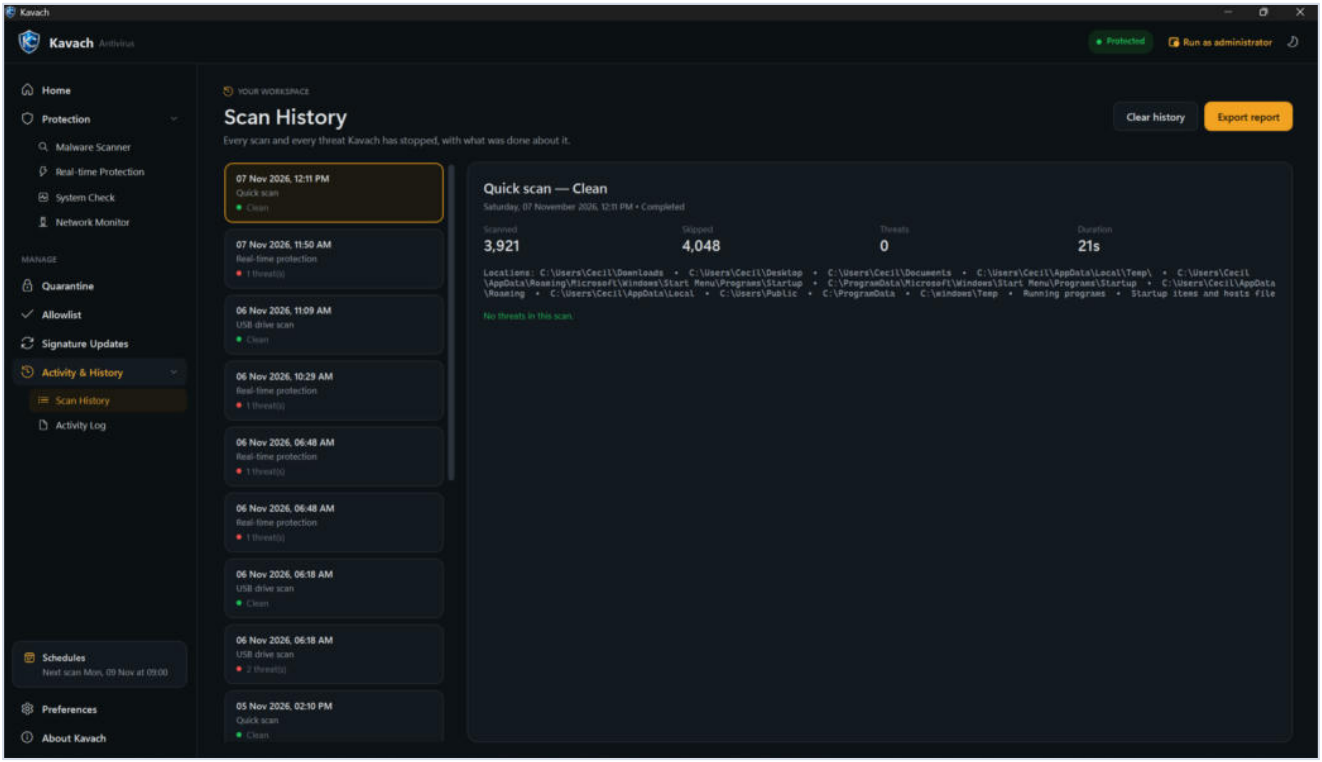


Signature Updates — counts, the Download latest button and ways to add your own signatures

- **Download latest**: fetches the free ReversingLabs detection rules from GitHub. No account is needed. The Kavach service also does this **by itself once a day**.
- **Import hash list**: load a .txt or .csv file full of SHA-256 hashes (for example a MalwareBazaar export).
- **Import YARA rules**: load a .yar / .yara rule file. Kavach checks each rule and skips features it does not support.
- **Add one hash**: paste a single SHA-256 hash and give it a threat name.
- **Loaded files**: shows which signature files are in use. **Open signatures folder** and **Reload** are here too.

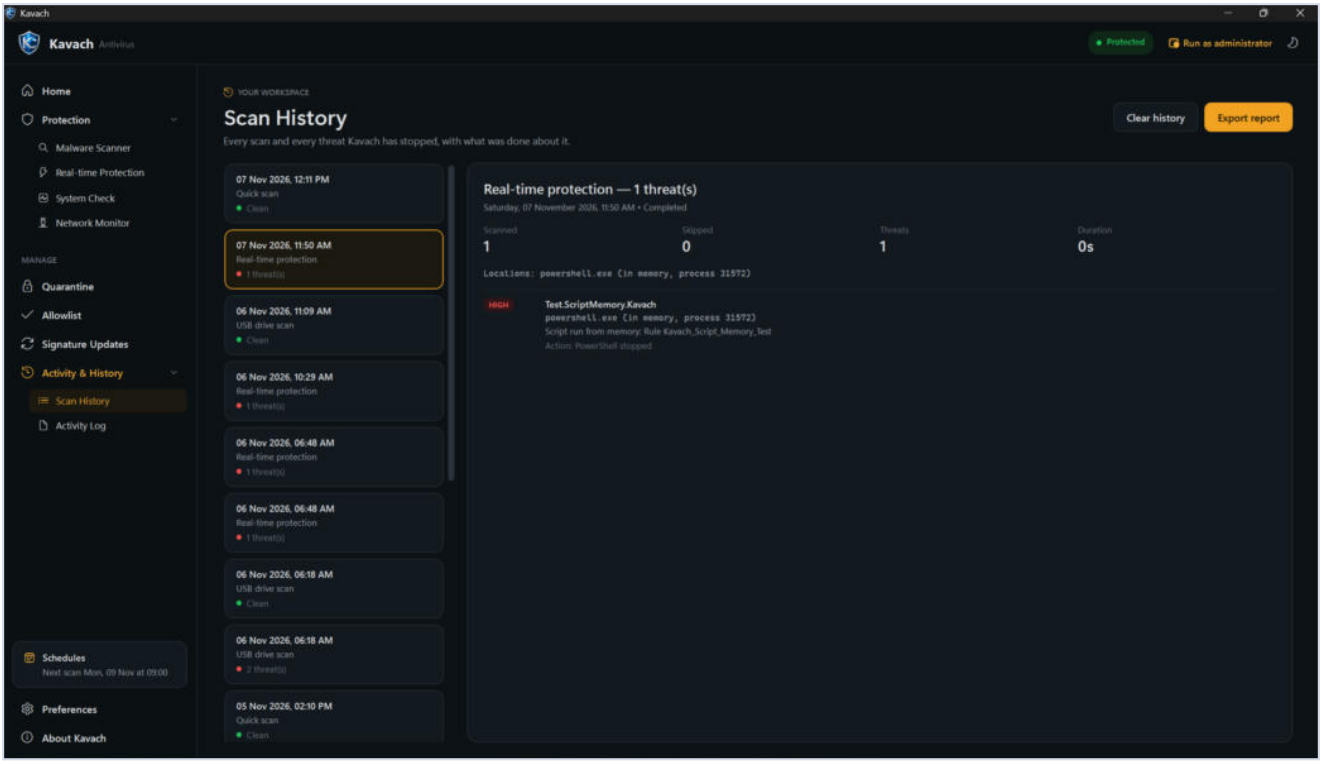
11. Scan History

Open it from **Activity & History** → **Scan History**. Every scan and every threat Kavach stopped is listed here, newest first.



Scan History — click an entry on the left to see its details on the right

- A **green dot** means the scan was clean; a **red dot** shows how many threats were found.
- The details show what was scanned, skipped, found, how long it took and which places were checked.
- **Export report**: save the selected scan as a PDF, CSV or TXT. **Clear history**: empty the list.

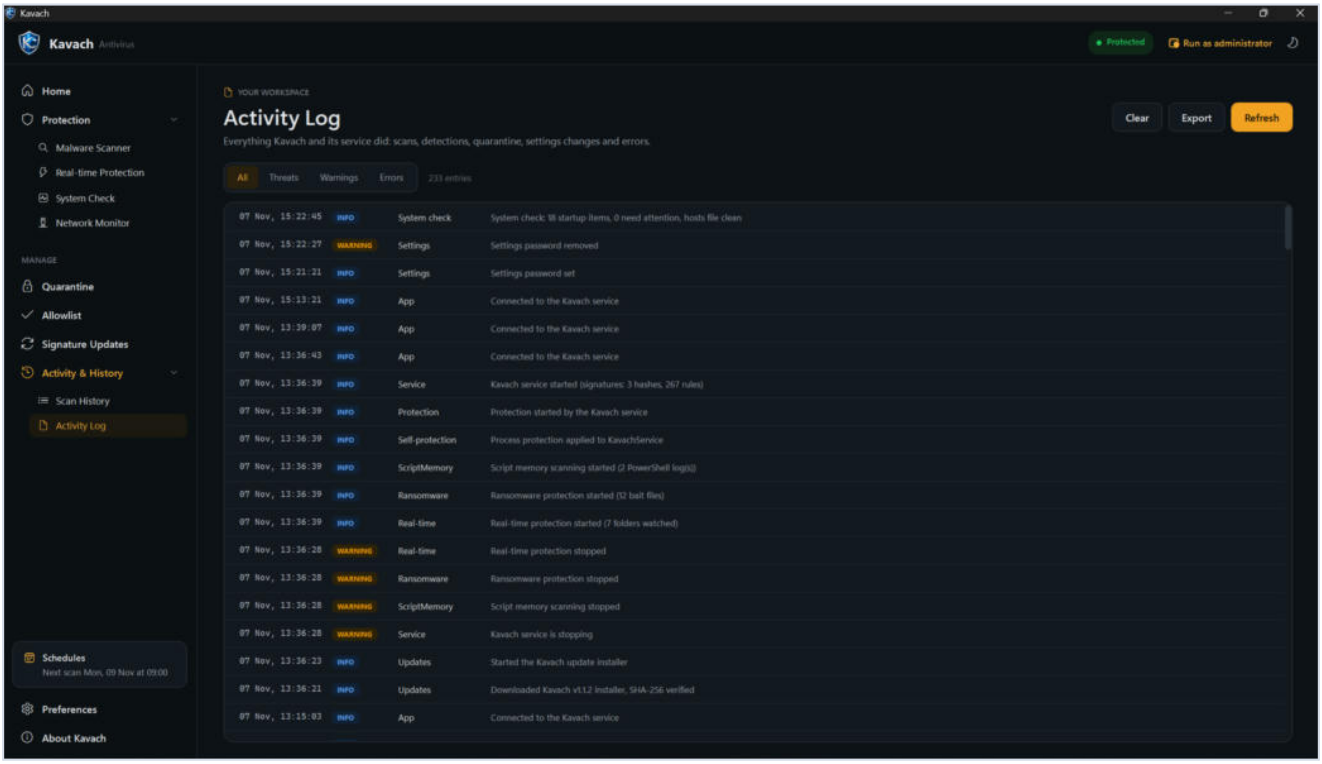


A threat entry — Kavach stopped a hidden PowerShell script running in memory

Each threat shows its **level** (LOW, MEDIUM, HIGH, CRITICAL), its **name**, **where** it was found, **why** Kavach flagged it and **what Kavach did** (quarantined, stopped, reported).

12. Activity Log

Open it from **Activity & History** → **Activity Log**. This is Kavach's diary: everything it and its service did.

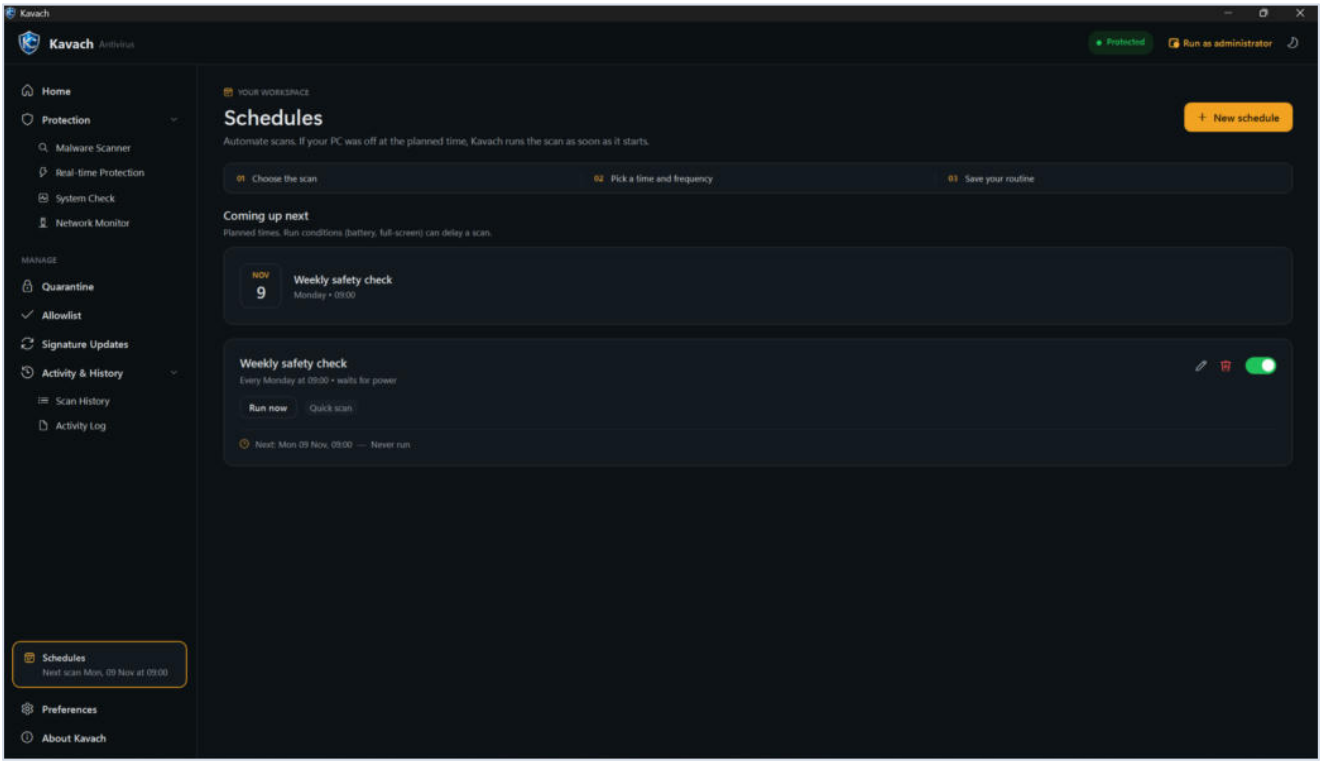


Activity Log — scans, detections, settings changes, updates and errors with time and type

- Filter with **All / Threats / Warnings / Errors**.
- **INFO** = normal event, **WARNING** = something worth knowing, **ERROR** = something failed, **THREAT** = malware was found.
- **Export** saves the log to a file, **Refresh** reloads it, **Clear** empties it.
- If something seems wrong with Kavach, this is the first place to look.

13. Schedules

Open it by clicking the **Schedules** card at the bottom-left. Kavach can run scans for you automatically.



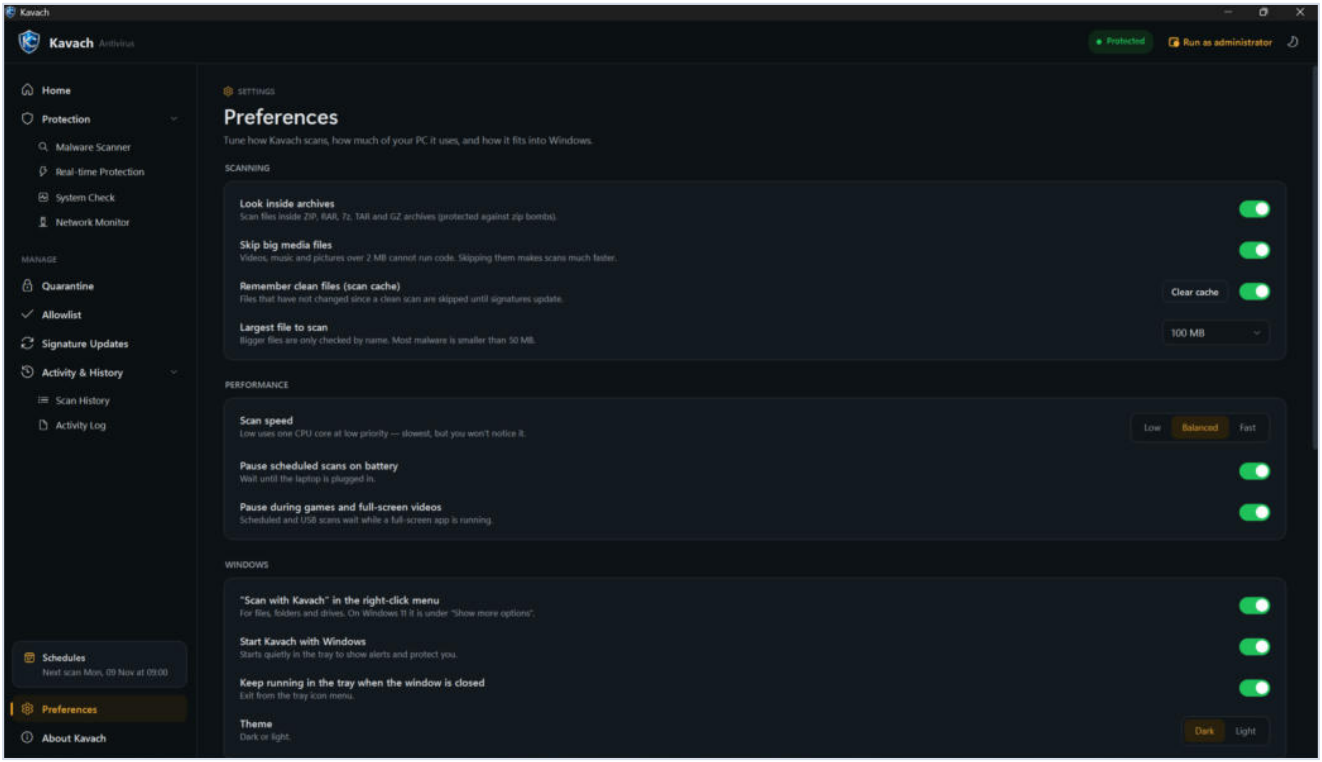
Schedules — the next planned scan and your scan routines

1. Click **New schedule**.
2. Choose the scan (Quick, Full or Custom), the day(s) and the time.
3. Save. The routine appears in the list with its next run time.

- **Run now**: start that scan immediately.
- **Pencil**: edit. **Bin**: delete. **Switch**: turn the routine on or off.
- If your PC was off at the planned time, Kavach runs the scan as soon as the PC starts.
- A scan can wait while the laptop is on battery or a full-screen game or video is running (see Preferences).

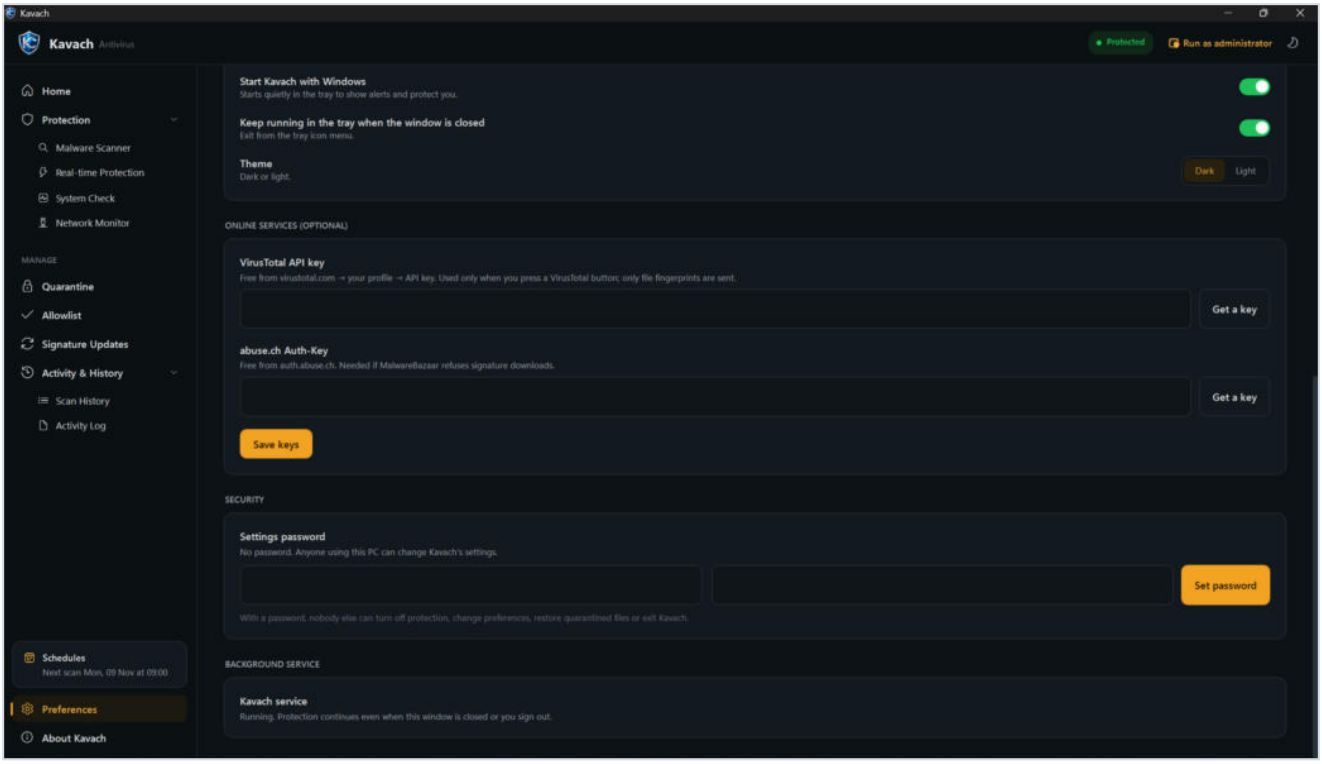
14. Preferences

Open it from **Preferences** (bottom-left). Here you decide how Kavach scans, how much of your PC it uses and how it fits into Windows.



Preferences — Scanning, Performance and Windows settings

Setting	What it means
Look inside archives	Also scan files inside ZIP, RAR, 7z, TAR and GZ archives (protected against zip bombs).
Skip big media files	Videos, music and pictures over 2 MB cannot run code, so skipping them makes scans faster.
Remember clean files	Unchanged clean files are skipped until signatures update. **Clear cache** forgets them.
Largest file to scan	Bigger files are checked by name only. Most malware is smaller than 50 MB.
Scan speed	**Low** uses one CPU core (slowest, you won't notice it), **Balanced**, or **Fast**.
Pause on battery / full-screen	Scheduled and USB scans wait until you are plugged in or have closed the game or video.
“Scan with Kavach” in right-click menu	Adds Kavach to the right-click menu of files, folders and drives.
Start Kavach with Windows	Kavach starts quietly in the tray to show alerts.
Keep running in the tray	Closing the window keeps Kavach in the tray. Exit from the tray icon menu.
Theme	**Dark** or **Light** (also the moon/sun button at the top).



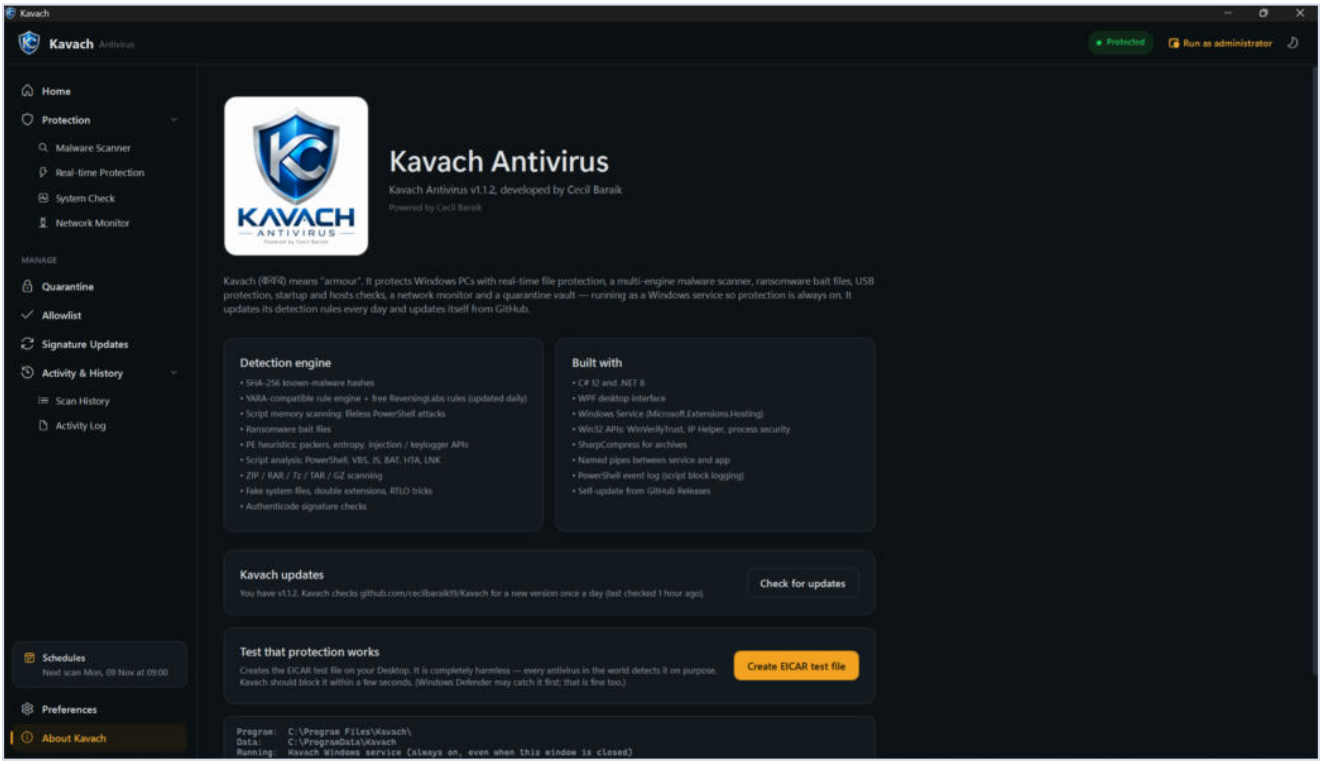
Preferences — online services, settings password and the background service

- **Online services (optional)**: a free **VirusTotal API key** enables the VirusTotal check; an **abuse.ch Auth-Key** adds MalwareBazaar hashes to updates. Kavach works fine without both.
- **Settings password**: type a password twice and click **Set password**. Then nobody else can turn off protection, change preferences, restore quarantined files or exit Kavach without it. **Remove** deletes it.
- **Kavach service**: shows whether the background protection service is running.

> **Don't forget your password**
>
> If you set a settings password and forget it, you will need to reinstall Kavach. Write it down somewhere safe.

15. About Kavach and updates

Open it from **About Kavach** (bottom-left).



About Kavach — version, detection engine, technologies, updates and the EICAR test

- Shows the version (here **v1.1.2**), what the detection engine does and what Kavach is built with.
- **Kavach updates**: Kavach checks **github.com/cecilbaraik19/Kavach** once a day. Click **Check for updates** to check now.
- When a new version exists, click **Download and install**. Kavach downloads it, checks its SHA-256 fingerprint (a changed file is deleted, never run), and installs it. Click **Yes** when Windows asks. Kavach restarts by itself.
- **Create EICAR test file**: see section 18.
- **Open data folder / Open program folder**: where Kavach keeps its data (C:\ProgramData\Kavach) and program (C:\Program Files\Kavach).

16. Kavach outside the window

Tray icon

The Kavach shield near the clock shows Kavach is running. **Double-click** it to open Kavach. **Right-click** it for quick actions such as Quick scan, turning protection on or off, and Exit.

Right-click scan

1. Right-click any file, folder or drive in File Explorer.
2. On Windows 11 choose **Show more options**.
3. Click **Scan with Kavach**. Kavach opens and scans just that item.

Pen drives

Plug in a pen drive and Kavach scans it automatically. A notification shows the result. Threats are quarantined, and autorun tricks are blocked. The scan is listed in Scan History as **USB drive scan**.

Notifications

Kavach shows a Windows notification when it stops a threat, blocks ransomware, stops a fileless attack, warns about a download or finds a new Kavach version.

17. When Kavach finds a threat

Don't panic — Kavach has usually already stopped it. Do this:

1. Read the alert: the **threat name**, the **level** and **where** it was found.
2. Open **Scan History** and click the entry to see why Kavach flagged it and what it did.
3. If the file is something you don't know, or came from an unknown website or email: leave it in quarantine, or delete it from the Quarantine page.
4. If you are sure it is a false alarm (for example your own program): **Restore** it and let Kavach trust it.
5. Run a **Full scan** to make sure nothing else is hiding.
6. If it was ransomware or a password stealer, change your important passwords from a clean device.

Level	Meaning
LOW	Unusual but probably harmless. Have a look.
MEDIUM	Suspicious behaviour or hacking tool. Check it.
HIGH	Very likely malware. Kavach quarantines it.
CRITICAL	Dangerous right now (for example ransomware). Kavach stops the program and quarantines it immediately.

18. Testing that Kavach works

- **EICAR test file**: **About Kavach** → **Create EICAR test file**. It is a harmless file that every antivirus detects on purpose. Kavach should catch it within a few seconds. (Microsoft Defender may catch it first — that is fine.)
- **Ransomware test**: run **tests\ransomware-test\RUN-RANSOMWARE-TEST.bat** from the Kavach project. It safely writes junk files and touches a bait file; Kavach should stop it. If Windows' own *Controlled folder access* is on, it may block the test first.
- **Fileless attack test**: run **tests\script-memory-test\RUN-SCRIPT-MEMORY-TEST.bat**. Kavach should stop the hidden PowerShell command within seconds.

19. Problems and answers

Problem	What to do
The badge says “Not protected”	Go to Real-time Protection and turn it on. Check that the Kavach service is running (Preferences, bottom).
Kavach flagged my own file	That is a false alarm. Restore it from Quarantine and trust it, or add its folder to the Allowlist.
“Unknown publisher” when installing	Normal — the installer is not code-signed yet. Click More info → Run anyway.
Kavach can't remove a threat	Click Run as administrator and try again.
Windows blocks Kavach's bait files	Windows Security → Ransomware protection → Allow an app → add KavachService.exe. The installer normally does this.
I forgot the settings password	Reinstall Kavach.
How do I close Kavach completely?	Right-click the tray icon → Exit. Protection still runs in the service.
Does Kavach replace Microsoft Defender?	No. Keep Defender on as well. Kavach adds extra protection.
Where are reports and data?	C:\ProgramData\Kavach (settings, history, logs, quarantine, signatures).